

Why
Daddy's Law Firm
works with
the Nice
Oil Men



Oli Frost & Ellen McGahey



“Daddy... the kids at school
said your law firm helps with
fossil fuel extraction.”

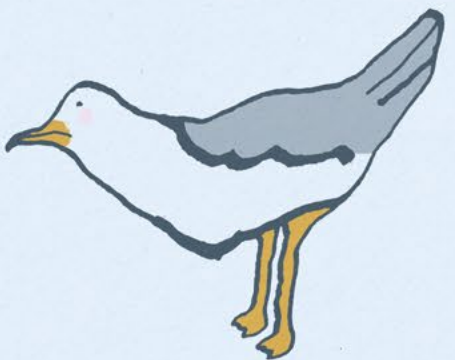
“Yes, we do
contracts for deals,
that finance expansion.”

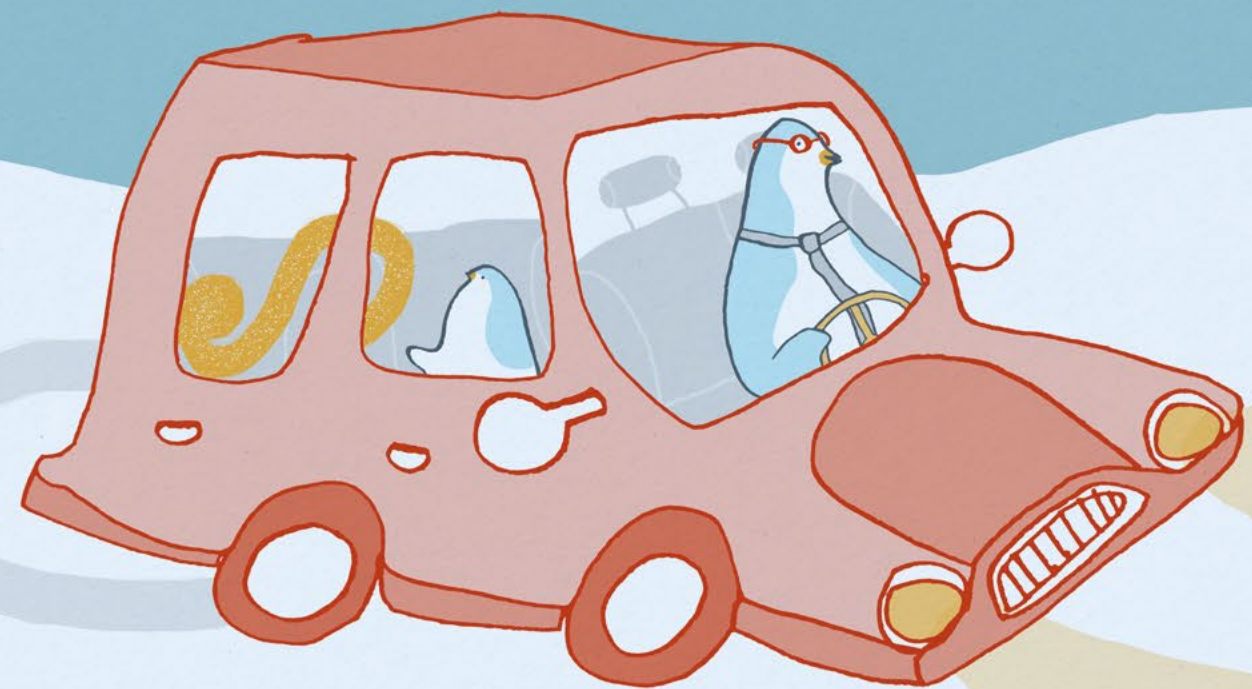


“Won’t
burning
more oil mean
more people
get
killed?”



“Well we don’t
burn the oil,
we just help it
get
drilled.”





“Would you help **make bombs,**
or help sell **cigars?**”



“Of course
not, that’s
taking it
too far.”





“Can’t you
help the
solar people make the
scary weather
stop?”



“We help
all kinds
of clients,

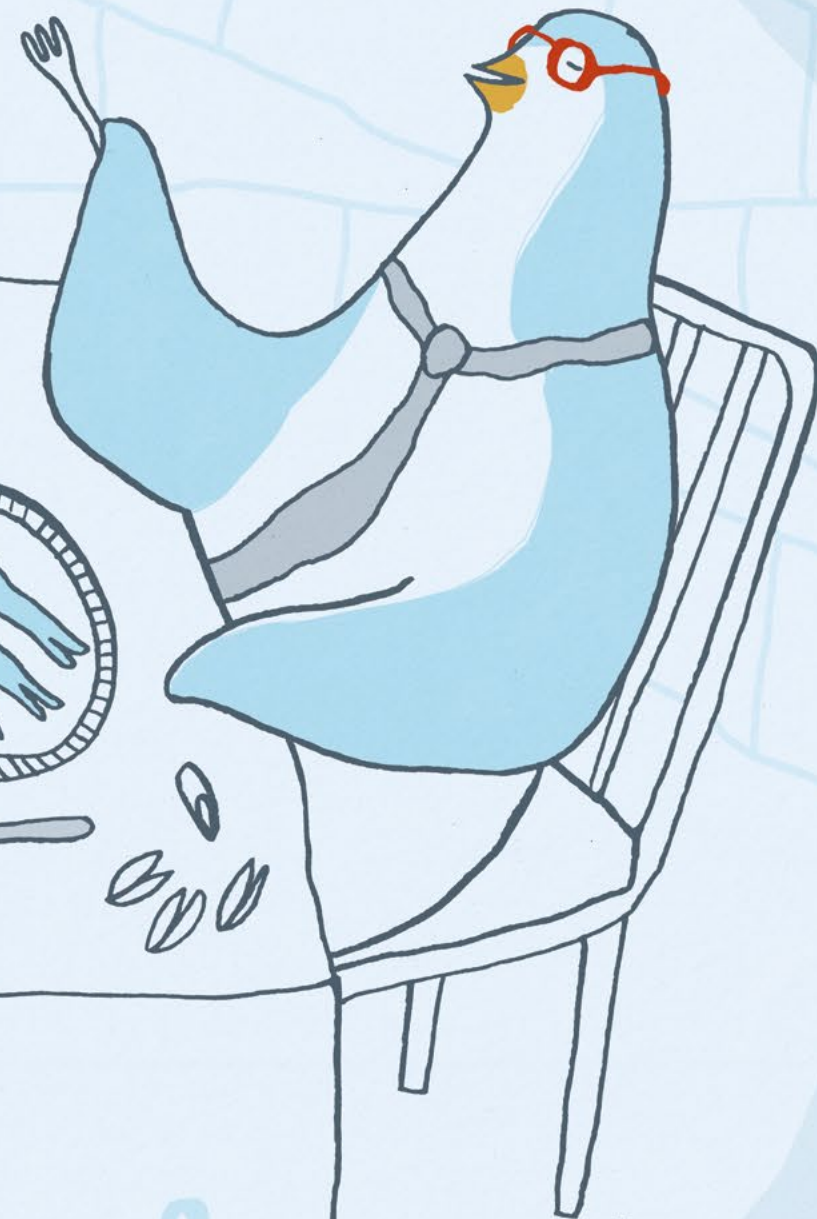
whether they’re
good for the planet
or not.”

“Isn't it
dangerous
to help
high
emission
clients?”

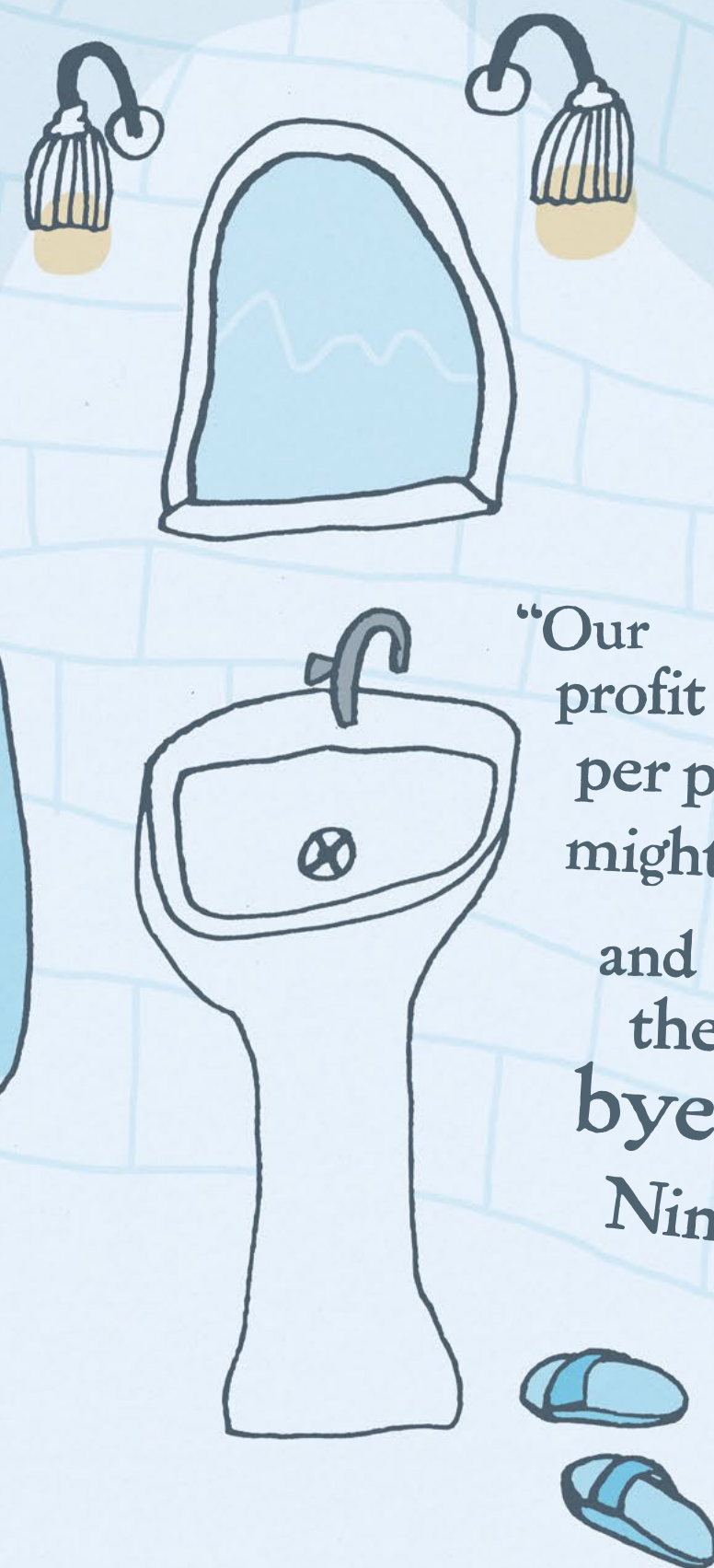


“Maybe it is.

But we do
law, ^{not}
science.”



“When
the clients do
bad things,
can't you
just say **no?**”



“Our
profit equity
per partner
might **fall,**
and
then it's
bye bye
Nintendo!”



“What
big questions
for a
penguin
so small...

But there’s
nothing
we can do,
nothing
at all.”

“Well
what
about...”



Climate impact scoring tools,
or client disclosure policies.
So people know if their firm
works with polluting companies.

Or a way to stop lying about
the climate we're changing.
If lawyers' duty of competence
required climate science training.

If award rankings considered
a client's scope three emissions.
Or lawyers in harmful industries
got help to make a transition.

And what if governance and employment
decisions factored in environmental toll.
So lawyers stopped taking money
from every ars...”



“What a **big** imagination!”

Good
night.

Sleep well.”

“Daddy has to
get up early
to do paperwork
for Shell.”





Did you know?

In 2025, the International Court of Justice ruled that countries have a legal duty to protect the climate and prevent harm to future generations, including fossil fuel expansion.

This includes regulating the private sector.

Between 2020 and 2024, London law firms facilitated

\$59.84 billion

in fossil fuel transactions*

*Source: The 2025 Law Firm Climate Change Scorecard by Law Students for Climate Accountability



The world already has enough approved fossil fuel projects to push past 1.5°C of warming.

Each 0.1°C beyond that increases:

Deadly heat waves and crop failures.
Mass displacement and climate refugees.
Wildfires, flooding and storms.

The communities that contributed least to emissions will be hit first and hardest.

Including penguins, who didn't emit anything at all.

7 Things Lawyers Can Do...



1

Learn the science and history.

To fulfill their duty of competence, lawyers should stay up-to-date on climate risks and understand the fossil fuel industry's history of deception.



2

Expand ethics rules.

Expand and enforce professional codes to explicitly prohibit misleading courts or the public about climate science.

3

Disclose fossil fuel work.

Require law firms to publicly report which oil and gas companies they represent and lobby for.



4

Stop rewarding harmful work.

Reform legal awards and rankings to stop celebrating lawyers destroying the planet.

5

Give clients transparency.

Create tools showing law firms' Scope 3 emissions so clients can choose representation aligned with their values.



6

Embed climate in firm decision-making.

Make environmental and human rights considerations central to hiring, partnerships, career development, and firm governance.

7

Refuse fossil fuel work.

Doing so on a 'climate-related protected belief' means you are unlikely to face regulatory action.





Discover more Penguin Adventures...

Daddy's Hiding from the ICJ Ruling

There's A Smelly Climate Activist In My Room

The Very Hungry Global Economy

Goodnight Coastal Infrastructure

Where The Wild Things Were



On a chilly winter night, a little penguin
dared to wonder: *if Daddy loves me, why does
his law firm facilitate fossil fuel expansion?*

Why Daddy's Law Firm Works with the Nice Oil Men is an instant
modern classic, suitable for all ages. Beautiful illustrations on every page
offer instant child-appeal, but its universal message – that it's ok to be
complicit in climate breakdown – gives it lasting value.

"Now our kids wake up screaming less"

Parent

"A sound legal argument for participating in a global crisis"

Lawyer

A penguin award winner.
Published by Serious Penguin.

SeriousPeople.co/Penguin